

3.21 Use of data in statistics

As set out in the Department for Education's *Mathematics: AS and A-level content* document, students studying A-level Mathematics must:

- become familiar with one or more specific large data set(s) in advance of the final assessment (these data must be real and sufficiently rich to enable the concepts and skills of data presentation and interpretation in the specification to be explored)
- use technology such as spreadsheets or specialist statistical packages to explore the data set(s)
- interpret real data presented in summary or graphical form
- use data to investigate questions arising in real contexts.

This requirement is common to all exam boards.